

To Dr L.J. Heaphy,

I am writing to submit our manuscript titled "Candidate Instruments for a Universal Carbon Premium: The Commonwealth Cost of Carbon" for consideration as a Perspectives article in Environmental Development. This submission was presented at the 3rd International Conference on Environment and Sustainable Development.

The manuscript provides a timely, critical evaluation of basic theory towards discovery of a universal ecosystem performance observation. Specifically, this article argues that following the Hobbesian position allows one to estimate a "Commonwealth Cost of Carbon" using simple and elegant methods that do not require privileged access. Through combining a leading transdisciplinary understanding of the social contract and environmental economics, we have been able to develop a completely novel perspective on the economics of climate change that has many relative benefits. Not only could this novel insight yield benefits for worldwide civic participation, but also allows a history of carbon premiums to be estimated with much higher certainty than competing views.

We believe this manuscript is an ideal fit for Environmental Development because it directly aligns with the journal's emphasis on research and practices that contribute to globally relevant environment and development issues at local and regional scales. It specifically addresses your audiences interest in innovative research applications, methods and practices that balance the need for development with the long term needs of society and the natural environment.

By submitting this work, I confirm that:

- The article is 2960 words long.
- The manuscript is original and is not currently under consideration for publication elsewhere.
- All authors have approved the final manuscript and agree to its submission to Environmental Development.
- There are no conflicts of interest to disclose.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration of our work.

Best wishes,

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